

Relationship Coach Scope of Practice

Document ID	TG-POL-03	Effective	March 1, 2026
Applies to	Relationship Coaches (Non-Clinical)	Owner	Clinical & Compliance Team

At a Glance

In scope	Communication skills, dating strategy, goal-setting and accountability, skills-level conflict de-escalation, habit-building, relationship check-ins.
Out of scope — refer	Any diagnosable mental health condition, trauma processing, grief therapy, substance use, suspected abuse disclosures.
Immediate escalation	Any mention of self-harm or suicidal thoughts, at any severity — goes straight to Emergency Protocol (TG-POL-05), not a standard referral.
Golden rule	Coaching is forward-looking and skills-based. If a topic requires clinical assessment or treatment, it isn't coaching — refer it.

1. Purpose & Applicability

This policy defines the scope of practice for Relationship Coaches on Togethr. Coaching is a non-clinical, non-licensed role. Coaches are not required to hold a mental health license, though many hold an ICF (International Coaching Federation) credential or equivalent relationship-coaching certification recognized by Togethr.

Coaching and therapy are fundamentally different disciplines. Coaches must not present themselves as, or perform the functions of, a therapist or counselor at any point.

2. What Coaching Is

Coaching on Togethr is goal-oriented, forward-looking, and skills-based. A coaching relationship helps clients set and pursue concrete relationship goals, build communication skills, and stay accountable to changes they want to make. Coaching does not diagnose, treat, or process past psychological trauma.

3. Topics Within Scope

- Communication skill-building (active listening, expressing needs, giving feedback)
- Dating strategy and pattern awareness for single clients
- Goal-setting and accountability for relationship milestones

- General conflict de-escalation techniques taught at a skills level, not therapeutic processing
- Day-to-day relationship satisfaction check-ins and habit-building (date nights, appreciation practices, shared routines)
- Preparing for specific relationship conversations (e.g., discussing moving in together)

4. Topics Strictly Out of Scope

Coaches must not attempt to address the following under any circumstances. These require immediate referral per Section 5 below, and — where noted — immediate activation of Emergency Protocol (TG-POL-05):

- Any diagnosable mental health condition (depression, anxiety disorders, PTSD, bipolar disorder, personality disorders)
- Trauma processing of any kind, including childhood trauma, sexual trauma, or relationship trauma
- Grief therapy (a coach may offer general support but must refer for anything beyond brief acknowledgment)
- Any mention of self-harm or suicidal thoughts, at any severity — this is a mandatory, immediate Emergency Protocol trigger, not a referral
- Substance use or suspected substance use disorder
- Disclosure of domestic violence, abuse, or a client's safety being at risk from a partner
- Eating disorders or disordered eating

5. Mandatory Referral Triggers

A Coach must pause the coaching relationship and initiate a referral (TG-POL-04) the moment a client's disclosure falls into any of the following categories:

- Client describes symptoms consistent with a diagnosable mental health condition
- Client discloses a history of trauma they are actively struggling with
- Client mentions substance use as a coping mechanism
- Client discloses that a partner has been physically, emotionally, or financially abusive

Any disclosure of self-harm, suicidal ideation, intent to harm another person, or an active safety emergency does not go through the standard referral process — it goes directly to Emergency Protocol (TG-POL-05), immediately, without exception.

6. Session Structure

Coaching sessions are 30–45 minutes and are structured around a specific goal or action item agreed upon with the client. Coaches should open each session by briefly checking in on progress against the

prior session's action items.

7. Documentation

Coaches log a brief session summary (goals discussed, action items, any flagged concerns) within 24 hours. Any content that trips a mandatory referral trigger must be flagged immediately, not at the end-of-day documentation window.

8. Example Scenarios

- A single client wants help building confidence approaching conversations about exclusivity. This is squarely in scope as dating strategy and communication skill-building.
- A client wants an accountability structure for a weekly date night with their partner. In scope as habit-building.
- A client mentions they've been "really down" for the past several weeks and it's affecting their relationship. This should prompt a referral conversation per Section 5 — a Coach should not attempt to explore or treat this further, even supportively.
- A client discloses their partner has thrown things during arguments. This is a mandatory referral trigger (possible abuse) and, depending on details, may also warrant discussion with a supervisor about whether Emergency Protocol applies.

9. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What should a Coach say if a client brings up something out of scope?

A: Acknowledge it warmly without exploring it further clinically — for example: "That sounds really hard, and I want to make sure you get the right kind of support for it. Let's talk about connecting you with a therapist on the platform." Then initiate the referral flow.

Q: Is a Coach ever allowed to discuss a client's mental health at all?

A: A Coach can acknowledge what a client shares with empathy, but must not attempt to assess, treat, or provide ongoing support for mental health symptoms — that always triggers a referral.

Q: What if a client seems to be joking about self-harm?

A: Treat any mention of self-harm as serious regardless of tone. Emergency Protocol (TG-POL-05) applies the moment self-harm is mentioned, even if the client downplays it.

10. Related Policies

This document should be read alongside: Referral Protocol (TG-POL-04) and Emergency Protocol (TG-POL-05), which every Coach is required to know in full.